



Link vs. Solid Snake? Mario vs. Sonic? Super Smash Bros. Brawl pits your favourite video game characters against each other

*Solid's Solid Snake* and Sega's *Sonic The Hedgehog*.

Each arena has four players battling it out at a time and the objective, as you must have guessed, is to throw all the characters out of the arena and be the last man (or woman, beast, alien or mythical creature) standing.

The simple control scheme is typical of Nintendo's approach to even a fighting game, as you use just two buttons (A and B) and the four-way directional pad to take on all comers. One button applies the regular attack while the other will perform a 'smash attack'. But that does not mean motion-sensitivity has gone for a toss: the WiiMote does come into play by registering the angle in which you are holding it when you press the smash attack button to perform different kinds of manoeuvres.

Users can also avail of the Nunchuck attachment as a joystick to move the character, or use the 'classic controller' attachment or GameCube's gamepad.

By performing these attacks, a player fills up the damage meters of other players. As the meter's percentage goes up, the distance the character moves upon being attacked increases. At 100 per cent, the player will fly off the map upon receiving a single hit.

During a battle, different types of items magically appear in the arena, which can be used by the first person to pick them up. These can range from attack-heavy light sabres to little baskets of food that restore your health. The super mushroom is the coolest of the lot, causing the same effect on any character as a mushroom has on Mario.

The graphics in *Super Smash Bros. Brawl* are exquisite, with almost all the characters looking better than they ever did in their own games. The background of each arena is taken from one of Nintendo's vast collection of popular games, as is the theme music that plays throughout. This leads to some funny moments, such as when we once encountered Link and Solid Snake facing each other in the Princess' Castle with the Mario theme running in the background.

